

Austin Gardner

Customer Success & Post-Sales Executive

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Customer Success executive with nearly 20 years building and scaling post-sales organizations that own NRR, GRR, and the full customer lifecycle. Most recently led a 60-person global team at Higharc—delivering 112% NRR, <1% churn, and 2x YoY revenue growth across \$350K+ enterprise accounts. Previously built CS functions from the ground up through Series A–C at Syncari, Shopmonkey, and WordPress VIP, consistently driving 110%+ NRR, land-and-expand revenue, and scalable customer health systems. Known for partnering with Sales and Product to turn CS into a revenue engine—backed by data-driven health scoring, AI-powered automation (90% ticket deflection via LLM), and teams that deliver measurable customer outcomes.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Net Revenue Retention (NRR) & Gross Revenue Retention (GRR) Optimization • Land-and-Expand & Upsell/Cross-Sell Strategy • Customer Health Scoring & Early Warning Systems • CS Team Building & Scaling (Mid-Market to Enterprise) • Renewal & Expansion Pipeline Management • Cross-Functional GTM Alignment (Sales, Product, CRO) • Global Support Operations & SLA Management • Onboarding, Implementation & Time-to-Value Optimization • C-Suite Stakeholder Engagement • AI & Automation for Scalable CS Operations

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered 112% NRR and <1% churn while scaling a 60-person global CX organization across 4 departments (Success, Implementation, Training, Support)
- Built CS functions from scratch at three high-growth SaaS companies, scaling teams from 3–16+ and driving 99%–110%+ retention across \$21M+ ARR portfolios
- Created \$1M+ new Professional Services revenue stream and scaled Payments from \$5M to \$33M ARR through integrated expansion motions

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Higharc

May 2024 – Dec 2025

Head of Customer Experience

- Led 60-person global CX organization spanning Customer Success, Implementation, Training, Support, and Professional Services—owning NRR, GRR, and full post-sale lifecycle across enterprise accounts averaging \$350K+ ARR
- Delivered 112% NRR, <1% churn, and 2x YoY revenue growth by building customer health scoring frameworks, intervention playbooks, and executive reporting that enabled proactive retention and expansion
- Partnered with Sales on renewal and expansion pipeline—standardizing handoffs, defining coverage models, and driving upsell through CSMs who understood customer value deeply enough to identify expansion opportunities
- Built and launched Training & Enablement (125+ sessions, 500+ learners) and Professional Services (\$1M+ first-year revenue) from zero, directly increasing platform adoption, stickiness, and expansion revenue
- Drove cross-functional alignment with Product, Sales, and Finance—integrating voice-of-customer feedback loops, unifying ARR reporting, and accelerating time-to-value by 45%
- Built AskAgent, an LLM/RAG-powered support tool achieving 90% ticket deflection across 1,000+ knowledge blocks—scaling support quality without linear headcount

Syncari

Mar 2022 – May 2024

Head of Customer Experience

- Achieved 110%+ NRR over 4 consecutive quarters by redesigning CS operating model across Success, Onboarding, Support, and Training—tying customer health to measurable business outcomes
- Defined and executed land-and-expand strategy that delivered 3x expansion revenue growth from existing mid-market and enterprise accounts

- Reported to CEO; served on Executive team presenting to Board—built executive CX dashboard from scratch that aligned company strategy around customer health metrics and NRR optimization
- Built implementation and ProServ scoping frameworks that cut time-to-value by 50%, established onboarding playbooks, and scaled capacity to 10+ concurrent projects quarterly

Shopmonkey

Apr 2020 – Mar 2022

Head of Customer Success & Payments

- Built Customer Success function from the ground up—scaling team from 3 to 16 CSMs, establishing health scoring, QBR frameworks, and playbooks that drove 99% retention on \$21M+ ARR portfolio
- Partnered with Sales on shared revenue accountability, supporting Series A-to-C growth and 3x YoY revenue expansion through integrated renewal and upsell motions
- Launched Payments team from zero, delivering 2–8x subscription MRR growth (\$5M to \$33M ARR) through cross-sell into existing customer base
- Earned President's Club recognition from CEO/COO for customer-led revenue impact across retention and expansion

Automattic | WordPress VIP

Aug 2018 – Apr 2020

Director, Cloud Platform Sales

- Closed 7-figure enterprise deals averaging \$1M+ with Fortune 100 technical buyers including Samsung and P&G—demonstrating executive presence and ability to navigate complex, multi-stakeholder sales cycles
- Exceeded revenue bookings quota by 30–40% QoQ across 6 consecutive quarters; led enterprise e-commerce segment and digital transformation initiatives

Telaria (acquired by Magnite)

Feb 2017 – Aug 2018

Director, Customer Success & Account Management

- Managed team of 4 CSMs supporting \$35M portfolio—established QBR cadence, health scoring, and upsell strategy that drove 1.5x revenue expansion YoY
- Served as strategic partner for C-level stakeholders across mid-market and enterprise accounts, translating customer feedback into product roadmap input

YuMe (acquired by Nexxen)

Mar 2014 – Feb 2017

Sr. Customer Success Manager

- Drove growth across 25+ media brands (NBC, Samsung, LG, Sony Crackle) through executive QBRs, cross-selling, and portfolio optimization—improving CSAT 36% and expanding MRR

Lockheed Martin

Apr 2009 – Mar 2014

Partner and Operations Manager

- Managed 50+ delivery partners and \$3M+ budget in regulated environment, ensuring 100% on-time product delivery

EDUCATION

B.S. Industrial Engineering — California Polytechnic State University & Azusa Pacific University

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

CS & CRM: Salesforce • HubSpot • PlanHat • Totango • Intercom • Zendesk • ClickUp • Asana

Analytics & Product: Looker • Pendo • PostHog • JIRA • Productboard • Gong • Stripe

AI & Automation: Claude • OpenAI • Gemini • n8n (workflow automation) • Replit • LLM/RAG architecture